Digital Procurement and Vendor Onboarding

MetroLink Regional Transit Authority I Solicitation ML-2026-041 I 3 November 2026

OPPORTUNITY AT A GLANCE

MetroLink Regional Transit Authority invites qualified suppliers to propose a secure digital procurement and vendor onboarding service. The Authority currently manages supplier registration, due diligence, contract documents, and renewal reminders across email, shared drives, and separate finance tools. The selected solution should provide a consistent, auditable experience for suppliers and internal reviewers.

ISSUING ORGANIZATION	**MetroLink Regional Transit Authority (fictional)**
SOLICITATION	**ML-2026-041 I Open competitive procurement**
ISSUE / CLOSING DATE	**3 November 2026 / 15 December 2026, 16:00 local**
CONTRACT TERM	**Initial 3 years, with two optional 1-year extensions**
PROCUREMENT CONTACT	**Procurement Office I procurement@example.invalid**

Purpose and outcomes

Reduce supplier onboarding effort, improve completeness of due diligence, shorten approval delays, and give staff a traceable view of each supplier's status. All names, dates, and figures in this test pack are fictional.

SUBMISSION AND EVALUATION

Submit a technical response, completed compliance schedule, implementation plan, service model, and separately identified commercial response. Evaluation weights are: functional fit 30%, security and privacy 20%, implementation and support 20%, supplier experience 15%, and total cost of ownership 15%. Clarification questions are due 24 November 2026.

Procurement note

This is a fictional sample for testing document ingestion and requirements analysis. It is not a real tender and creates no offer, contract, or procurement obligation.

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SCOPE AND FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS

The proposed service will support the supplier lifecycle from initial invitation through registration, due diligence, approval, active maintenance, and renewal. The Authority expects configuration and integration with its existing Microsoft 365 and finance environments; replacement of the finance system is not in scope.

GOAL-001 **BUSINESS OUTCOME**

Reduce median time from complete supplier application to onboarding decision from the current 12 business days to no more than 6 business days within six months of launch.

FR-001 **SUPPLIER REGISTRATION**

Provide a responsive supplier portal with save-and-resume registration, organization details, tax and banking data, contact roles, and document uploads. Applicants must receive a confirmation and a reference number.

FR-002 **VALIDATION AND REVIEW**

Validate mandatory fields and document expiry dates; route complete applications to the appropriate Procurement, Finance, and Risk reviewers. Reviewers must be able to request corrections and record a reason for rejection.

FR-003 **APPROVAL WORKFLOW**

Support configurable approval paths by supplier category and estimated annual spend. The workflow must record approver, decision, timestamp, comments, and any delegation.

FR-004 **RENEWALS AND ALERTS**

Notify the supplier and assigned owner at 90, 60, and 30 days before insurance or certification expiry. Escalate an overdue review to the Procurement Manager after 5 business days.

FR-005 **AUDIT AND EXPORT**

Maintain a searchable history of application changes and decisions, and allow authorized staff to export a supplier record and its audit history in a commonly readable format.

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QUALITY, INTEGRATION, AND CONTROL REQUIREMENTS

FR-006 **MICROSOFT 365 INTEGRATION**

Import approved supplier documents from a designated SharePoint library and store final records in the Authority's approved Microsoft 365 tenant. Exact folder taxonomy and metadata mapping will be agreed during discovery.

FR-007 **FINANCE INTEGRATION**

Send approved supplier master data to the existing finance system through a supported API or controlled file exchange. The supplier must describe retry, reconciliation, and duplicate-detection behavior.

NFR-001 **AVAILABILITY**

The service must achieve 99.9% monthly availability, excluding agreed maintenance. The service schedule elsewhere in this solicitation describes a four-hour recovery time objective.

NFR-002 **SECURITY**

Encrypt information in transit and at rest; enforce role-based access and multi-factor authentication for staff; log privileged access and material record changes.

NFR-003 **PRIVACY AND RETENTION**

Collect only information needed for supplier onboarding. Support configurable retention and legal hold. The Authority's precise retention schedule is to be confirmed before configuration.

NFR-004 **ACCESSIBILITY**

The supplier portal and staff review screens must conform to WCAG 2.2 AA and support keyboard-only operation.

CON-001 **HOSTING**

Supplier and financial data must remain in a cloud region located in the United Kingdom. Any subprocessors and cross-border support access must be disclosed.

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DELIVERY, SERVICE, AND COMMERCIAL RESPONSE

NFR-005 **PERFORMANCE**

For a normal business load of up to 250 concurrent users, 95% of portal pages must load within 3 seconds, measured at the service boundary.

NFR-006 **DISASTER RECOVERY**

The service schedule in the service requirements states a recovery point objective of 15 minutes. The separate operational appendix states that backups are taken nightly; bidders must identify any conflict and propose a resolution.

CON-002 **BUDGET CEILING**

The Authority's indicative implementation budget is GBP 240,000 excluding VAT. Recurring service charges must be shown separately for each contract year.

Expected delivery includes discovery and design, configuration, integration, migration of up to 8,000 active supplier records, user acceptance testing, training, production launch, and 60 days of hypercare. Bidders must identify client dependencies, assumptions, exclusions, and proposed acceptance evidence for each phase.

REQUIRED RESPONSE CONTENTS

- Executive summary and understanding of MetroLink's objectives.
- Solution overview, architecture, data flows, integrations, and hosting region.
- Completed requirement-by-requirement compliance schedule with evidence and exceptions.
- Delivery plan, governance, roles, risks, service levels, and support arrangements.
- Separate one-time and recurring pricing, including assumptions and optional services.
- Accessibility statement, security controls, privacy approach, and subprocessor list.

Known ambiguity for analysis

The four-hour recovery time objective conflicts with nightly-only backups if both describe the same service tier. The RFP does not state whether 99.9% availability includes planned maintenance; bidders should flag both points.